

going on with the stock he had recommended. He said he had been selling the stock all day. He just stitched me. That was a bad experience.

What do you mean he stitched you?

He recommended buying the stock, which I did. The next day he smashed the stock.

When you say “stitched you,” you mean he set you up.

Yes. I thought he was a friend, but he wasn't a friend. Some people who you work with for years and think will support you will do nothing to help you, while other people you know in passing may be very helpful. It really taught me a lot about human nature and made me think again about whom you can and can't trust.

How much did you lose on that stock tip? Did you lose as much as you made on the big trade on the first day?

I lost more than that. The fund had been running a few months, and I was going to show a 10 percent loss as of the end of the month. There was a total disconnect between my feelings and reality. In my head, if I was down 10 percent, my business would be over. No one ever would give me money to manage. I had no perspective. I had no older person to put his hand on my shoulder and say, “Calm down. Just do the things that work and stop doing the things that don't.” I can remember sitting at the kitchen table, my head in my hands, staring into an abyss. I put so much pressure on myself to make money every day. *I must make money. I must make money. I must make money.* And I was having a very hard time making money in the market. It felt like the market was kicking me around.

I woke up one morning around 4 A.M., lying in bed, feeling sick in my stomach, and thinking, *What is the market going to do to me today?* I closed the business that day. It was an incredibly tough experience. If only I had someone to give me perspective and say, “Slow down. You're not trying to make 500 percent. Stop thinking in absolute terms and start thinking in terms of percentages.”

What did you do after you closed your fund?

I went to Nomura where I started a risk arbitrage business.